In



1925, A NEW ARCHITECTURAL MOVEMENT WAS BORN AT THE *Exposition Internationale des Arts Décoratifs et Industriels Modernes* in Paris. In October, a first-of-its-kind twin-city celebration marking 100 years of the Art Deco movement called Art Deco Alive! kicked off in Miami in the US and will continue in India in Mumbai in November. It links the cities through their shared architectural legacy—Miami has the world's largest collection of Art Deco buildings, and Mumbai comes a close second. The American celebration, from October 8-31, included an exhibition titled *From Ocean Drive to Marine Drive: Mapping a Century of Art Deco* that explored its evolution from Paris to Miami and Mumbai through archival drawings, design objects and photographs. This was supported by leading preservation institutions, including the Miami Design Preservation League and Art Deco Mumbai Trust.

Smiti Kanodia, who is founder and Mumbai curatorial director of Art Deco Alive!, says, "Mumbai and Miami are united by their dynamic spirit, architectural heritage and shared identity as cultural confluences." She narrates how Art Deco Alive! started as a casual conversation while touring Miami's Deco district. Co-founders and Miami curatorial directors Gayatri Hingorani Dewan and Salma Merchant Rahmathulla became friends when they both lived in New York, while Smiti knew Gayatri from their time together as students at NYU. Salma, who is an advocate for cultural preservation, elaborates on the similarities

> The exhibition will highlight women like **Art Deco pioneer Perin Mistry** and preservation activist Barbara Baer Capitman

THEATRE

The Stage is Set

Prithvi Festival kicks off from November 1 with a bouquet of plays, fringe performances and more

For more than four decades, the Prithvi Festival has been an annual reminder of Mumbai's abundant love for the performing arts, evident in the way the city turns up to celebrate creativity, collaboration and cultural dialogue. Come November, the iconic theatre venue will host the festival once again. Many new plays, experimental works, stage talks and workshops with theatre personalities as well as Indian classical music and dance performances are in the pipeline.

"There's an inherent buzz of activity that takes over this time of the year. We never have pre-decided themes, but this year, there seem to be several shows that centre around issues of womanhood," says Zahan Kapoor, trustee, Prithvi Theatre.

Some plays this year include Yuki Ellias's *A Fish Ate My Cat*, Mahabanoo Mody-Kotwal & Kaizaad Kotwal's *Eden Creek*, Daniel D'Souza's *Queen*, Mohit Takalkar's *Anatomy of a Suicide*, Akarsh Khurana's *A Perfect Time to Panic* and Atul Kumar's *Ambaa*. Dastangoi Collective's *Dastan-e-Guru Dutt* will delve into Bombay noir while *Dastan Raja Vikram ke Ishq Ki* is based on folk tales by scholar A.K. Ramanujan and the poetry of Mir Taqi Mir.

THIS YEAR, THE FESTIVAL **IS INTRODUCING WORKSHOPS** WITH LEADING EXPERTS TO ENCOURAGE STUDY AND PRACTICE IN THE PERFORMING ARTS

